

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive trends in page weight, protocols, and security

Jan 2020 – Mar 2026 crawl window · Desktop and mobile measurements

~16M

Desktop URLs

Plateau since mid-2023

~12.5M

Mobile URLs

Plateau since mid-2023

99%+

HTTPS requests

Effectively universal

~40%

HTTP/3 support

Fastest protocol shift

Audience: web performance engineers and front-end architects evaluating infrastructure trends

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



~5M

Desktop URLs in Jan 2020

~3.5M

Mobile URLs in Jan 2020

~15M

Desktop by mid-2022

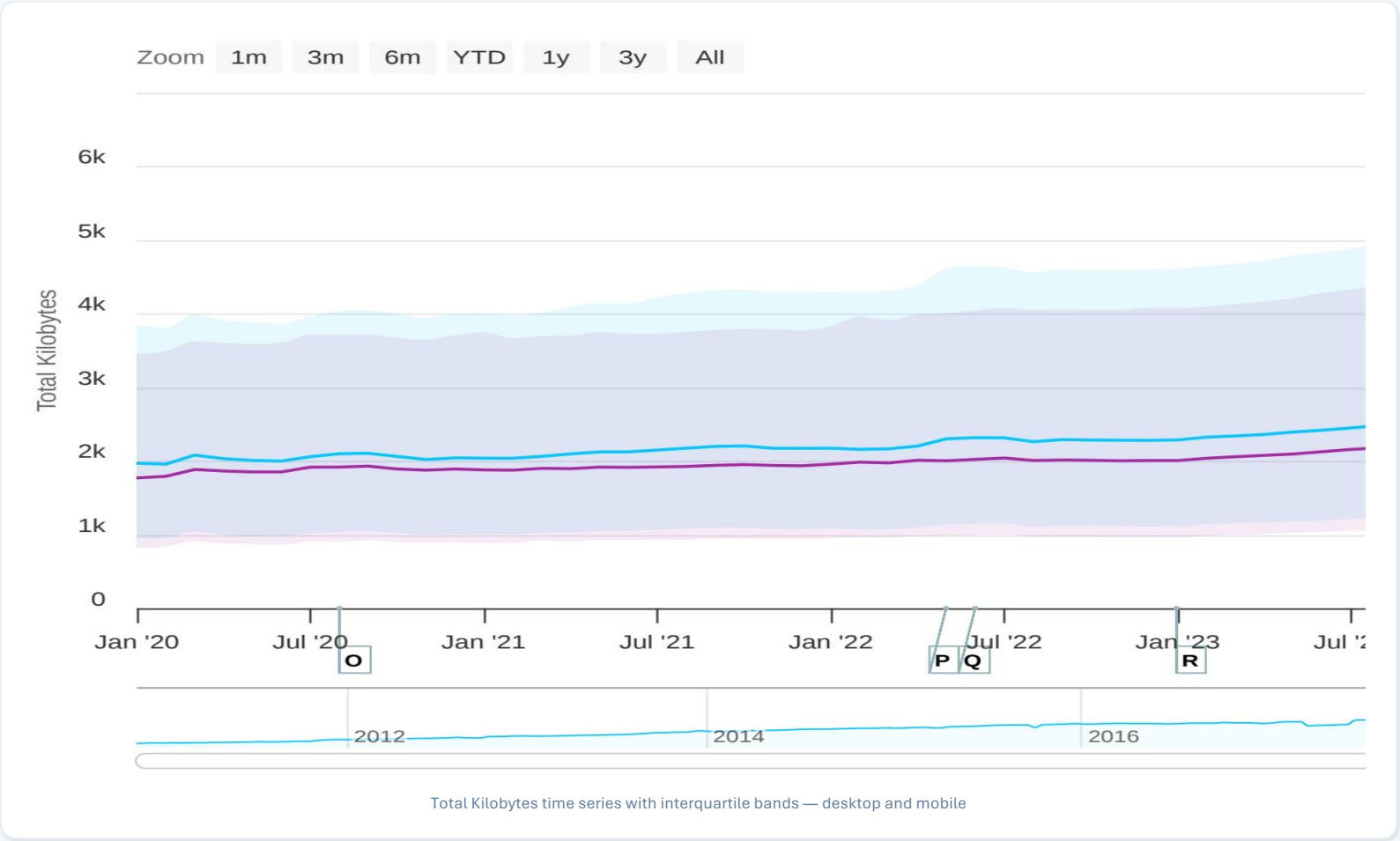
~10M

Mobile by mid-2022

Current plateau

Stabilized around ~16M desktop and ~12.5M mobile URLs by mid-2023 onward.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



~1,600

KB

Desktop median in early 2020

~2,000

KB

Desktop median now

~1,900

KB

Mobile median now

>4,000

KB

75th-percentile desktop

Interpretation

Median desktop pages are roughly 25% heavier than in 2020. The upper quartile shows a long tail of heavyweight experiences.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Median requests per page

76

Desktop requests

▲ 2.7% over period

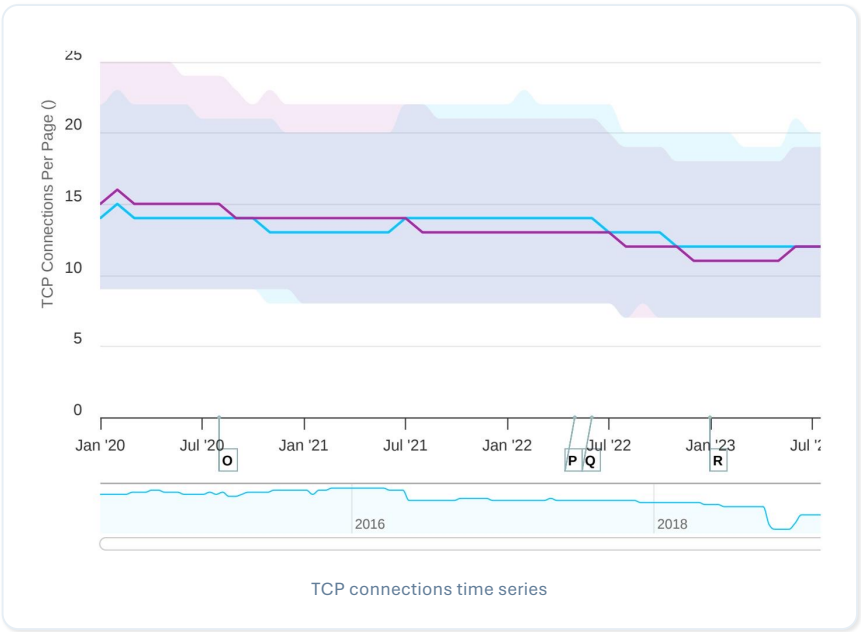
71

Mobile requests

▲ 2.9% over period

Request growth remains modest while pages get heavier, indicating payload size—not just request fan-out—is a key contributor.

TCP connections per page decline



12.0

Desktop now

▼ 14.3%

11.0

Mobile now

▼ 26.7%

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 allows many resources over fewer TCP connections.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

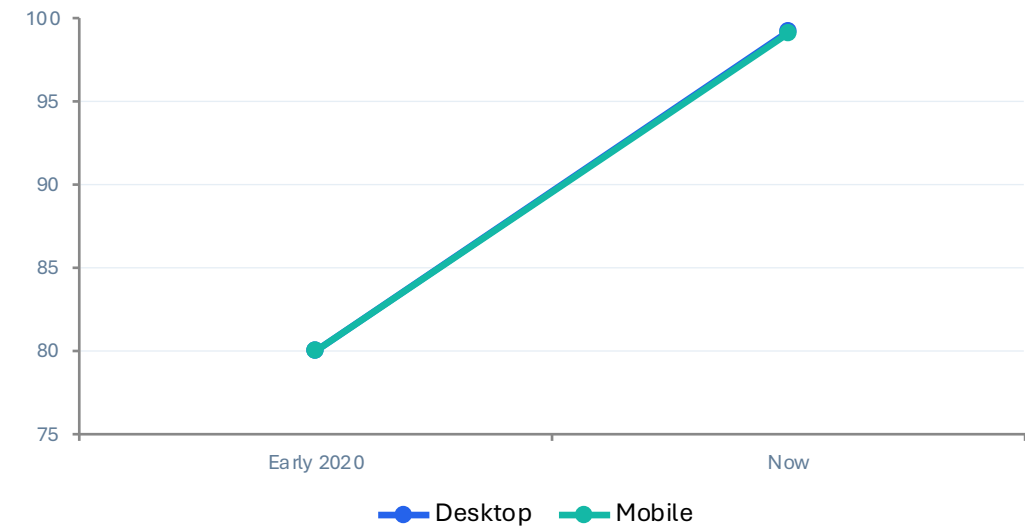
99%+

of requests use HTTPS

99.2% desktop · 99.1% mobile

Up roughly 19–20 percentage points since early 2020, when adoption was around 80%.

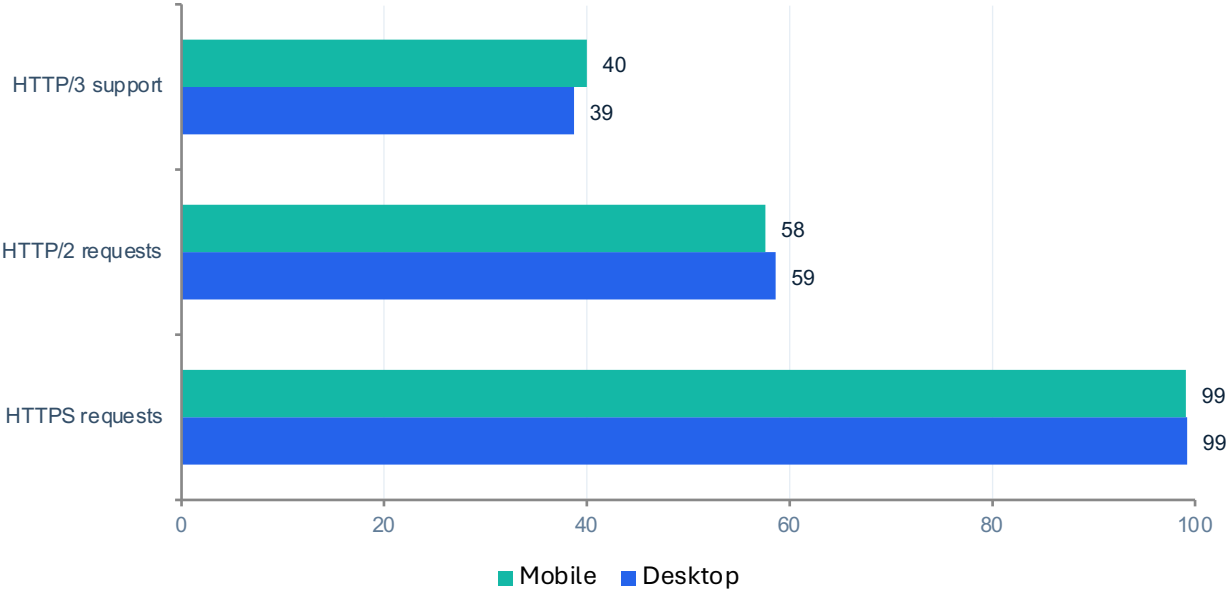
Climb from ~80% to 99%+



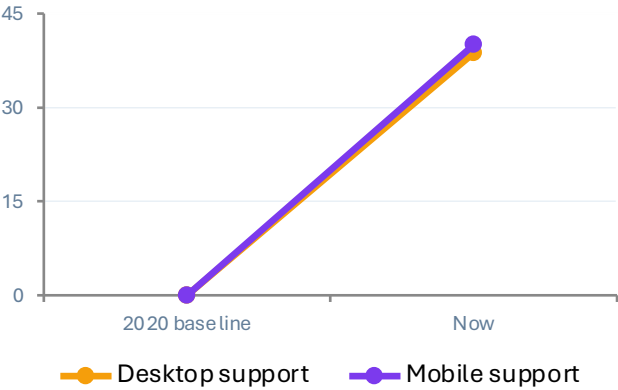
Plaintext HTTP is now effectively absent from the modern request path.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

Latest protocol snapshot



HTTP/3: near zero → ~40%

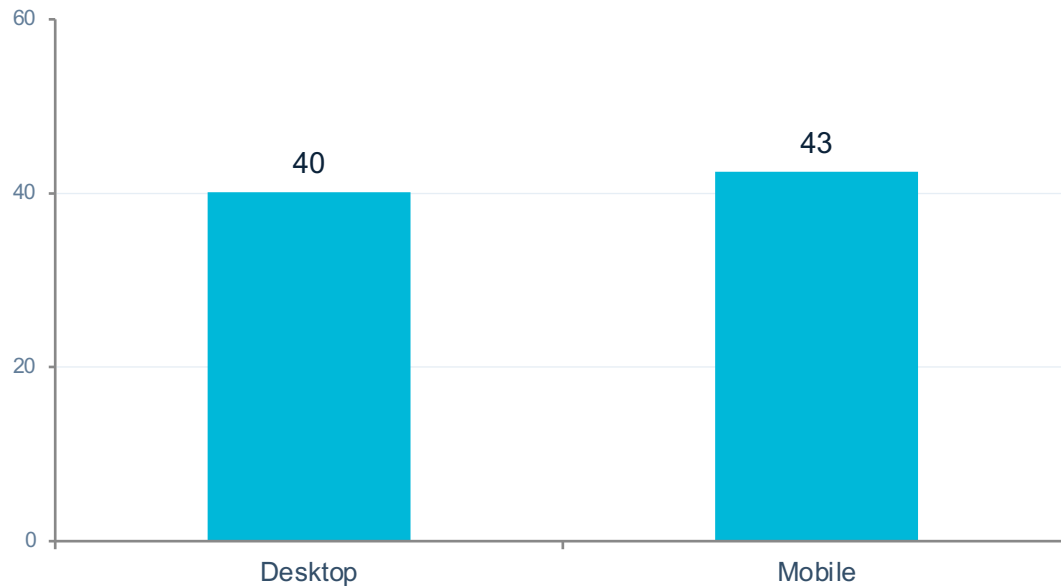


HTTP Archive reports HTTP/3 support rather than actual usage because fresh Chrome instances start with HTTP/2 before Alt-Svc discovery.

CAVEAT

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Latest adoption by crawl type



40.1%

Desktop pages
use font-display

42.5%

Mobile pages use
font-display

14.9%

Desktop increase
since 2020

61.0%

Mobile increase
since 2020

Why it matters

The CSS `font-display` property helps avoid Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT). More than half of pages still risk invisible text during web font loading.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Bigger pages, smarter protocols, stronger security

01

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop transfer is ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than 2020.

02

HTTPS is the new baseline

99.2% desktop and 99.1% mobile requests use HTTPS.

03

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

Support reaches 38.7% desktop and 40.0% mobile from near zero.

04

Connections decline despite more requests

Median TCP connections fall to 12.0 desktop and 11.0 mobile.

05

Font-display remains an optimization gap

Adoption is 40.1% desktop and 42.5% mobile; more than half still risk FOIT.

Benchmark next

Compare your own properties against these HTTP Archive baselines: KB, request count, connection count, HTTPS, HTTP/2/3, and font-display.

ACTION